Remote Support: RDP (Remote Desktop Protocol)

RDP (Remote Desktop Protocol) is a Microsoft protocol that allows you to remotely access and control another Windows computer over a network or the internet. It enables a user to view and operate the remote computer as if they were sitting in front of it.

Key Features

- Remote access to Windows desktops and servers.
- Full control of the remote computer (keyboard and mouse).
- File and clipboard sharing between local and remote systems.
- Printer, audio, and drive redirection.
- Supports multiple monitors and high-resolution displays.
- Encrypted communication for secure remote sessions.

Requirements

- The remote computer must have **Remote Desktop** enabled.
- The remote computer must be powered on and connected to the network.
- You need the **IP address or hostname** of the remote computer.
- A valid username and password with permission to log in.
- Network access (VPN or port forwarding if connecting over the internet).

How to Connect

1. Open **Remote Desktop Connection** (mstsc) on your Windows computer.
2. Enter the remote computer's IP address or hostname.
3. Click **Connect**.
4. Enter your username and password.
5. After authentication, the remote desktop session starts.

Common Uses

- IT help desk and technical support.
- Remote administration of servers.

- Working from home by accessing an office computer.
- Managing applications on a remote machine.

Advantages

- Easy to use and built into Windows.
- Secure encrypted connections.
- Supports resource sharing (files, printers, clipboard).
- Provides a complete desktop experience.

Limitations

- Available only on Windows Pro, Enterprise, and Server editions as the host.
- Requires proper network configuration for internet access.
- Performance depends on network speed and latency.

Common RDP Port

- **TCP Port 3389** (default)

Security Best Practices

- Use strong passwords and enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) where possible.
- Restrict RDP access through a VPN or firewall.
- Enable Network Level Authentication (NLA).
- Keep Windows updated with the latest security patches.
- Disable RDP when it is not needed.

RDP is one of the most widely used remote support tools in Windows environments because it provides secure, full desktop access for administration, troubleshooting, and remote work.